DOCUMENT 1

Market Requirements Document (MRD)

1.1 Problem statement and scope note

Problem. Travellers in Tamil Nadu choose hotels using price and star rating alone. Two hotels with the same 4.4 rating look identical, and nobody can tell in advance whether the gym, pool or restaurant will be crowded. Once inside the hotel, guests waste time walking to busy facilities and waiting without knowing how long.

Scope note (demo-able in 1.5 days)

- Who: guests looking for a hotel in Tamil Nadu, and the hotel staff who serve them.
- What: rank hotels by what the guest needs, take a pre-booking request, and show a live crowd heat map of the hotel's facilities.
- How: software only. Hotel data from OpenStreetMap; crowd counts typed by hotel staff. No cameras, sensors or paid data.
- Not in scope: online payment, real-time sensor feeds, trained AI prediction models.
- Demo: one complete flow from search → pre-book → staff accepts → guest sees crowd map → queue token.

1.2 Target segments

SEGMENT	WHO THEY ARE	WHY THEY MATTER
Leisure and family travellers	Families and couples visiting temple towns, hill stations and cities such as Madurai, Chennai, Coimbatore, Kodaikanal	Book 1–3 nights, care about facilities and comfort, travel during festival rush
Budget and student travellers	Students, interview candidates, small groups on a fixed budget	Very price-sensitive; need the best value within a strict limit
Hotel managers (mid-size hotels)	Front-desk managers and owners of 20–100 room hotels	Want more visibility and fewer complaints about crowded facilities, without buying hardware

1.3 Personas

Priya, 34 · Family traveller

Chennai · travelling to Madurai with husband and child

Goals: a clean hotel near the temple, under ₹2,500/night, with a pool for her son.
Pain points: many hotels look the same; arrived at a pool last trip that was packed; does not want to pay online to an unknown hotel.
Today she: scrolls booking apps, reads reviews, calls reception to ask about the pool.

Arun, 21 · Student traveller

Trichy · attending a placement drive in Coimbatore

Goals: cheapest decent room close to the venue for 2 friends.
Pain points: prices hidden until checkout; no way to compare two similar lodges quickly; prefers Tamil.
Today he: asks friends on WhatsApp, checks Google Maps, picks by gut feel.

Ravi, 42 · Hotel front-desk manager

Mid-size hotel, Madurai

Goals: fill rooms, keep guests happy, update information quickly.
Pain points: guests complain the gym is always full at 7 AM; no budget for sensors; listing sites show outdated details.
Today he: answers phone calls, keeps a paper register at the gym door.

Stays Admin · Platform operations

StayZen team

Goals: only show trustworthy hotels and accurate information.
Pain points: fake or outdated listings damage trust; hard to see which hotels stopped updating.
Today: no tool exists; this is a new role created by StayZen.

1.4 Market need: evidence and assumptions

- Guests choose hotels on price and rating, but equal ratings give no way to decide. **[A]** to be confirmed by a short survey of 20 travellers.
- Crowded facilities during peak hours (gym 6–9 AM, pool and restaurant in the evening) are a common complaint. **[A]** based on team members' own hotel stays and conversations, not measured data.
- Many travellers in Tamil Nadu are more comfortable in Tamil than English. **[A]**
- Mid-size hotels will not buy cameras or sensors for crowd counting, but staff can type a head count in under 10 seconds. **[A]** to be tested with one hotel manager.
- **Verified:** OpenStreetMap contains 603 hotels and 714 restaurants across 38 Tamil Nadu districts (team's own Overpass export). Most entries have names and locations but no prices or facility details.

Note on numbers. We have not used market-size statistics in this document because we could not verify them. All figures above come either from our own data export or are marked as assumptions.

1.5 Alternatives today and the gap

ALTERNATIVE	WHAT IT DOES WELL	WHAT IT MISSES

Large booking apps (MakeMyTrip, Booking.com, Goibibo)	Big inventory, reviews, payment	Rank by price/popularity, not by the guest's own needs; no facility crowd information; Tamil support limited
Google Maps	Location, distance, reviews, "popular times" for some places	No booking flow; popular times rarely available for facilities inside a hotel
Calling the hotel	Direct answers	Slow, depends on staff, no comparison between hotels
Paper register at the gym or pool	Free, simple	Guests only find out after walking there

The gap: no product helps a guest pick the hotel that fits *their* needs *and* then tells them, inside the hotel, which facility is quiet right now and how long the wait is, without hardware.

1.6 Opportunity and why now

Smartphone use is near-universal among travellers, free open map data now covers every Tamil Nadu district, and AI assistants make Tamil and English conversation cheap to offer. A software-only product can give mid-size hotels a "smart hotel" experience at almost zero cost, and give guests a reason to choose StayZen over generic booking apps.